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Wellington & District LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharanea, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbon and Yeoval districts.

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THURSDAY, AUGUST 6, 2026 ISSN 2653-2026

WELLINGTON RACE CLUB

Racing at Wellington Thursday August 13

Full TAB -7-race card

It's a great day out!!

PCYC Basketball revival - P 3

Buddhist Centre working bee - P 7

Eisteddfod results to date - Page 9

Eisteddfod attracting hundreds

IT'S BEEN a big week, and big weekend at the Wellington Civic Centre as this year's Wellington Eisteddfod kicked-off in full swing last Tuesday.

Tuesday and Wednesday were devoted to Music from piano to percussion while from Saturday it was the popular dance section which continued through to yesterday.

Locals and visitors found it hard to find a car parking space within the CBD on the weekend, even outlining normally empty streets were full to the brim as the dance section attracted hundreds from near and far.

But that's a postive sign that this year's Eisteddfod is being a success.

And also, even with the extraordinary council hall hire expenses, our town has been abuzz with activity – the food outlets have definitely benefitted.

The music program results are published on Page 9 with many Wellington region young people gaining success.

Now the schedule turns to speech and school troupes finalizing on August 19.

Ablaze with prizes Twenty Stray Notes choir members sang beautifully last Wednesday night in five choral sections for an audience of 50 people.

Adjudicator and accomplished chamber musician Anne Stevens gave praise and encouragement, confirming a significant moment in time for our local choir, as they rise in vocal skill and commitment towards their 30th anniversary in 2027.

Afterwards 30-plus choir and audience piled into Black Cat Cocktails for celebratory drinks.



The Small Town section attracted groups from throughout Central and Western areas including this trio from Cobar's Momentum Dance Studio 7 & 8 Years - Kaiah Ataua, McKenna Barrett and Kelsey Coffey. More photos Page 5

Pre-Paid Funerals

Perhaps the best time to arrange a funeral is before it's needed, without the emotion and stress that often accompanies a death. A pre-paid funeral plan is a service planned and paid for in advance. It is secured at today's prices, which gives you total control over your funeral.

For more information about our pre-paid funeral options call on (02) 6845 2322

Wellington FUNERAL HOME

24 Nanima Cres, Wellington NSW 2820

Annual Household Chemical Cleanout this Sunday

DON'T FORGET the annual household chemical clean out will take place in Wellington this Sunday, August 9.

Drop off household quantities of chemical waste at the Wellington Waste and Recycling Centre on Nanima Village Rd from 11am until 2pm.

It's a great opportunity for residents to safely clean out their garage or shed and safely dispose of those unwanted household chemicals or paint for free. Only domestic household quantities are accepted with 20L or 20kg the maximum container size.

The service is not available for businesses or commercial quantities.

For example, items that can be disposed of include garden and pool chemicals, household cleaners, hobby chemicals, poisons, batteries, paint, motor oils, fluids and fuels, fluoro lights, gas bottles, fire extinguishers and smoke detectors.

EARLY CHILDHOOD Education and Careers Forum

It was great to see a group of keen students from Wellington High School at the Early

Childhood Education and Careers Forum at the Dubbo Civic Centre on Tuesday of this week with their Careers Adviser Miss Pixton.

Students were able to connect with a wide range of employers, allied health services, paediatric nursing and training providers who service the Early Childhood sector.

Events such as this are very important for students to be able to talk directly to people employed in a particular industry. As the saying goes, 'If you can't see it, you can't be it'.

The event was a collaboration between Dubbo Regional Council, Workforce Australia Local Jobs Program - Far West Orana and the NSW Government through the Regional Industry Education Partnerships program.

Scientific kits available at Library

Discovery Boxes are loanable science kits from the library that encourage hands on, interactive learning in a fun way.

Each box is designed to provide a scientific experience covering lots of different themes.

There are about 50 different types of boxes to choose from, suited to different ages, so

pop into Macquarie Regional Library with your kids and discover something new!

Discovery Boxes must be borrowed on an adult card as they are designed to be used with adult supervision.

Pop into the library and check out the Discovery Boxes on offer!

Desex your pets!

Desexing your pet is important for many reasons, including:

- * Preventing unwanted litters
- * Improving pet health
- * Reducing problem behaviours
- * Helping protect native wildlife
- * Reducing stray animal numbers
- * Minimising impact to animal services

Find out more in the Pet Owner Information section of the Council webpage.

New Waste Vouchers

The new 'My DRC Waste Vouchers' have been launched, which gives eligible households the opportunity to choose how you want to dispose of excess waste.

The new vouchers replace the previous 1x Tipping Voucher and 1x Bulky Collection Voucher default. Residents on 2 and 3 bin services can keep one of each, convert both vouchers to Bulky Rubbish Collections, or keep both as Tipping Vouchers.

The change follows a Council decision to continue the pre-booked Bulky Rubbish Collection service until June 2028.

For residents who find it hard to get to a Waste and Recycling Facility, being able to book two Bulky Rubbish Collections a year will make a difference.

All eligible residents will receive two Tipping Vouchers through the MyDRC Waste Portal. Residents who want to convert a voucher to a Bulky Rubbish Collection can do so through the portal, choosing a collection date based on their location.

Residents with a booked Bulky Rubbish Collection can place up to one box trailer of rubbish on the kerbside from the Sunday before their collection week.

The two-voucher system will remain in place until 2028, when Council will review the program alongside the renewal of its Waste Services contract.

Josh Black

Don't penalise local food and fibre production

FARMERS FROM across the state and across all commodities unanimously agreed that the NSW Government must urgently suspend land tax compliance of primary production until the current definition is resolved – including all current and planned investigations.

NSW Farmers Business, Economics and Trade committee chair John Lowe said Revenue NSW compliance activities have caused significant stress for small and medium sized farms that have been traditionally exempt from land tax.

"It is critical that the NSW Government acts now to ensure that the land tax exemption continues to support evolving, contemporary, and diversified farm businesses," Mr Lowe said.

"The definition of primary production land in land tax legislation has not been updated in over 25 years and is at risk of no longer reflecting modern farm businesses.

"Not updating the current primary production definition for land taxes not only risks food security and business resilience but also risks the NSW Government's existing government policies to promote risk management, agrifood development and agritourism being realised.

"Farm businesses that integrate

small-scale value-adding, agritourism, processing activities on-farm that are directly linked to the cultivation or maintenance of that land should remain eligible for the exemption."

Compliance has recently recommenced by the regulator causing significant uncertainty in the sector about how the current framework is being enforced.

Mr Lowe said the state government should align its land tax framework for primary production with other jurisdictions that support the sale of value-added agricultural products, such as Victoria where they recognize produce whether its sold in a natural state, is converted or processed.

"The definition of "primary production land" must not exclude genuine primary producer – recognising diversified on-farm activities which are complementary to, not competing with primary production."

NSW Farmers is seeking practical changes to the primary production definition in NSW that restores confidence and provides longer-term certainty for agriculture in the State including agritourism and value-add activities.

Government promises better mobile coverage for REZ communities

From ABC Western Plains

THE STATE government is spending \$14.5 million to boost mobile phone and internet coverage across the Central West Orana Renewable Energy Zone (REZ).

Telecommunications providers are being offered financial incentives to expand and upgrade network infrastructure where major renewable projects are being built.

It is expected to improve coverage across the 900-square kilometre REZ, helping farmers manage their operations and families access essential services and emergency responders.

Speaking at the New South Wales Farmers' Association's conference, the Energy Minister Penny Sharpe said the government was committed to helping the communities hosting the energy transition.

Country Education Foundation launches second Tim Fischer Fellowship

THE COUNTRY Education Foundation (CEF) has officially opened applications for the second year of the Tim Fischer Fellowship, building on the momentum of the Fellowship's inaugural year.

Individuals passionate about making a difference in rural and regional Australia through the power of education are encouraged to apply.

The Fellowship supports a recipient with up to \$50,000 in funding, mentorship and networking opportunities to help turn their bold ideas into reality. The proposed project must include an education element, whether through communities, workplaces, youth, students or other educational contexts to create meaningful change in regional and rural communities.

As applications open for the 2026 Fellowship, inaugural recipient Annabelle Hudson has reflected on the significant progress made in delivering her initiative, *True North* — a practical, student-centred program designed to recognise their strengths, expand their sense of possibility, and approach future education and career decisions with greater clarity and confidence.

Originally from Young, Ms Hudson is developing *True North* to address a gap she observed among regional students: not a lack of talent or ambition, but unequal access to exposure, tailored guidance and opportunities to explore what might suit them.

"*True North* has evolved from a powerful idea into something real and deeply meaningful," Ms Hudson said.

"I've spent time listening to students and educators in rural and regional communities and shaping the program around what they have shared to genuinely reflect their experiences, aspirations and challenges.

"What has stood out most is just how much potential exists when young people are given the space and support to recognise their strengths.

"Many students already have the capability to achieve incredible things — what they often need is greater self-belief and clearer pathways."

Country Education Foundation Chair, Nick Burton Taylor said the Fellowship continues to honour Tim Fischer's belief in the transformative power of education and opportunity.

"Tim believed deeply in the potential of people from regional Australia," Mr Burton Taylor said.

"He understood that talent is everywhere, but opportunity is not always equal.

"This Fellowship continues his legacy by helping bridge that gap and supporting people determined to create positive change."

Applications for the 2026 Tim Fischer Fellowship are now open and close on August 24.

AstraZeneca flips on decision

AFTER AstraZeneca announced they were pulling the life-saving breast cancer and endometriosis drug Zoladex from both the PBS and the private market (but keeping the men's 10.8mg dose for prostate cancer available), over 40,000 Australians signed a Change.org petition asking for them to reverse the decision.

After less than two months of campaigning, Astrazeneca has agreed to keep the women's drug available for free for eligible women indefinitely.

Approximately 8600 patients were dispensed Zoladex in the first three months of the year, and many were left considering removing their ovaries when it was announced the drug will be discontinued.

Report from Change.org Australia

Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Eucharéena to Elong Elong and Yeoval within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

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Olivia Barton selected for World Eventing Championships

FORMER Spicer’s Creek equestrian Olivia Barton, has been selected a member of the Australian Eventing Team in the Tenth World Championships at Aachen, Germany from August 13 to 16 and which are held every four years.

Olivia is one of five team members of which four will make up the team and the other will be selected as the team’s individual

She will be riding APH Sodoku pictured.

The Eventing series will begin with dressage, cross country and show jumping.

Other members are Oliver Barrett and Sandhills Briar; Sophia Hill and Humble Glory; Andrew Hoy and Vassily de Lassos, and Sam Woods and SS Eight Count.

Squadron Energy helps Wellington young people get active through local basketball program

Young people from Wellington are taking to the court through a community-run basketball program run by PCYC Wellington Club.

With the backing of Squadron Energy’s Uungula Wind Farm, the local initiative is running regular training sessions and drop-in basketball games for those looking to stay active, develop their skills and build new social connections.

The program has attracted an average of 10 to 12 participants at each session and has engaged more than 20 young people since it began.

PCYC Wellington Club Manager Aidan Carr said Squadron Energy’s support had expanded the club’s resources and provided local youth with a positive outlet.

“Through this support we have been able to provide training sessions as well as drop-in games, providing a safe space for young people to be involved and participate in the sport they enjoy,” Mr Carr said.

Squadron Energy First Nations Engagement Facilitator Justin Toomey-White said the basketball program was a great community initiative to get behind.

“Sport has a unique ability to bring people together, and this basketball program provides Wellington’s young people with opportunities to stay active, build confidence, make new friends and develop skills in a supportive environment,” Mr Toomey-White said.

“It’s fantastic to see young people getting involved, and we’re pleased our support is helping Wellington PCYC create an inclusive and engaging space where participants can connect through sport and celebrate their community.”

The program helped prepare PCYC Wellington’s basketball team for the PCYC Nations of Origin Tournament.

The Nations of Origin Tournament unites First Nations and non-First Nations young people to celebrate culture through sports, with strong endorsement and support from Elders.

The tournament was played in Sydney recently.



LEFT: Wellington PCYC Basketball players.



Team captain Riley Smith said the program had provided an enjoyable way for local young people to connect.

“The Wednesday afternoon basketball program is a great opportunity for after school to connect with people you might not otherwise,” he said.

“It has brought me friends from the shared love of basketball and has aided me in maintaining my physical fitness and overall health.”

Earlier in the month, the team played against PCYC Parkes in Wellington as part of the opening day of the competition, going down by 10 points.

PCYC Wellington also organised lunch, arts and crafts, gymnastics and cultural activities for participants as part of the school holiday program.

Yoga Classes first and third Sunday each month

Tai Chi Classes on Fridays

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New Waste Vouchers give residents more of a choice

RESIDENTS ARE the big winners with the launch of My DRC Waste Vouchers which give eligible households the opportunity to choose how they want to dispose of excess waste.

Council has launched MyDRC Waste Vouchers, replacing the previous one Tipping Voucher and one Bulky Collection Voucher default.

Residents on two and three bin services can keep one of each, convert both vouchers to Bulky Rubbish Collections, or keep both as Tipping Vouchers.

The change follows a Council decision to continue the pre-booked Bulky Rubbish Collection service until June 2028.

The service has run as a trial for two years, with 5765 collections booked by residents in that time.

Director Development and Environment Steve Jennings said the new system gave residents control that didn't exist before.

"In the feedback we received, households told us the old system didn't always suit them so now they can choose what works for their situation.

"For residents who find it hard to get to a Waste and Recycling Facility, being able to book two Bulky Rubbish Collections a year will make a difference."

Mr Jennings said the pre-booked Bulky Rubbish Collection trial over the past two years had shown strong take up from residents, while also helping divert waste from landfill.

"We've received some good feedback from residents who have used the pre-booked system, and this is another way of making it accessible for more residents at different times of the year," he said.

"The collections are made on an area-based system, so residents have many opportunities during the year to select a date and leave their rubbish on the kerbside for

collection.

"However, they also have the same opportunity to take it direct to a Waste and Recycling Facility, or to a transfer station at a time that suits them."

All eligible residents will receive two Tipping Vouchers through the MyDRC Waste Portal. Residents who want to convert a voucher to a Bulky Rubbish Collection can do so through the portal, choosing a collection date based on their location.

Residents with a booked Bulky Rubbish Collection can place up to one box trailer of rubbish on the kerbside from the Sunday before their collection week.

The two-voucher system will remain in place until 2028, when Council will review the program alongside the renewal of its Waste Services contract.

Around 21,500 residences across the region are eligible for the service, including rental properties.

Council is encouraging tenants to login to the My DRC Waste Portal and sign up to see what services their property is eligible for this financial year.

Waste Vouchers came into effect on 1 August. Residents can find more information at www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au.



In Their Sights

Fashions Mount Rifle Club

Results Saturday, August 1.

Hunting Class: S. Barnes 99.8, S. King 98.9, L. Hough 88, M. Clement 83.4, D. Gollan 58.1.

Next Shoot Saturday, August 15 at 900 yards.

The Rifleman

Local Clubs to Score Big with \$4.65 Million in Grants

COMMUNITY SPORTING organisations are being urged to get their boots on, with the State Government throwing open applications for \$4.65 million in Local Sport Grant Program funding.

The Program delivers grants to community sporting organisations for new equipment, programs and facility upgrades that support and encourage participation in sport and active recreation across the state, from grassroots clubs in regional towns to suburban sporting associations in Sydney.

Last year, \$4.49 million was awarded across NSW for 586 community sport projects, helping clubs put more people on the field, on the court and in the pool.

This year's program includes grants from \$2000 to \$20,000, with up to \$50,000 available in each electorate.

Funding will support projects that increase participation and retention, provide inclusive opportunities for under-represented groups, and strengthen the sustainability, capability and facilities of community sporting organisations.

Minister for Sport Steve Kamper said the Government was committed to breaking down the barriers that stop people getting involved in sport, whether that's the cost of new equipment, a lack of facilities, or programs that don't reflect the diversity of local communities.

Applications close 1pm, Monday, August 17.

Drought response needs a revamp

FARMER HAVE sought a revamp of drought response measures at the 2026 NSW Farmers Annual Conference, including incentives to enhance on-farm water and fodder storage.

The call to prioritise practical relief comes as almost half the state is predicted to be in drought by September, and farmers plan production outcomes with forecasts of El Nino weather patterns in mind.

NSW Farmers Justin Everitt said members were not satisfied with the current framework – with many reporting more tangible assistance on the ground was necessary. "Drought responses need to be practical with meaningful relief measures that support farmers manage and recover from drought, and prepare for the next one which is always just around the corner," Mr Everitt said.

Farmers are also keen for a return to formal drought declarations when there is sustained low rainfall (5 - 10 percent of historical records) over a sustained time period (6 - 12 months).



It's time to complete your Census.

Every answer matters

If you know where you'll be on **Census night, Tuesday 11 August**, you can complete the form for your household as soon as you get your instructions. Complete online, on paper or with help from us.

 census.abs.gov.au



Census

Authorised by the Australian Bureau of Statistics, Canberra

At the 2026 Wellington Eisteddfod



TOP LEFT: Dance HQ Orange 12 years - Miracle.

TOP RIGHT: UPA Studios, Mudgee, 12 years Modern group.

ABOVE LEFT: Adelaide Bltch and Sadie Corinth of Orange Dance HQ were in the 1and under Muscial Theatre group.

ABOVE: The Thompson family enjoying Saturday's schedule - Shirley, Chantelle (holdng Sullivan Hannelly) and Brooke.

LEFT: Stepping Out Dance Factory, Dubbo, 12 years Modern group.

The price of a 'Leader'
is just half the cost of a coffee



Andrew Gee at the sight of destruction.

Firearms regulation still not working for farmers

FARMERS VOICED the need to be heard in the development of the state's update to firearms regulations at the NSW Farmers Annual Conference. More than 200 conference delegates called on the NSW Government to urgently address feasibility issues for farmers in the new laws passed at Christmas.

NSW Farmers Vice President Justin Everitt said the sudden, sweeping changes to firearms laws made without consultation created unintended consequences for farm businesses.

“For farmers these are vital tools that are needed to do a job, and we’ve made it clear to the NSW Government that it needs to get the settings right around their new laws,” Mr Everitt said.

“If these are not addressed, implementation will cause further problems for operations and pest control.”

The conference agreed that the NSW Government must urgently address outstanding issues including:

- Exemptions from the mandatory gun club membership requirement.
- More feasible firearm caps including a reliable pathway to apply for additional firearms based on primary production requirements.
- Cumulative caps for licences based on their approved genuine reasons.
- Restoration of a merit review pathway to appeal licensing decisions.
- Fair compensation for licence holders required to surrender firearms to meet new requirements and avoid financial hardship.
- Recognition of the important role of recreational shooters in pest management for agriculture.

Trail of destruction continues on Wilpinjong Creek

NO EROSION control, no sediment control, every tree destroyed.

I was out near Ulan recently (north of Mudgee), with local farmer Emma Bowman, and the level of destruction along Wilpinjong Creek needs to be seen to be believed.

I’m not against renewable energy, but this whole thing started when the NSW National Party created the Central West Orana Renewable Energy Zone and then abjectly failed to properly regulate it.

Asleep at the wheel.

It’s a failure that has continued through successive Governments.

The result is:

- Shocking environmental destruction
- Inadequate landholder and neighbour protections
- Meaningless tick-a-box consultation
- No plan to protect our critically important agricultural land
- Neighbours pitted against neighbours
- Absentee foreign companies flipping projects to make a quick buck
- A massive power imbalance between developers and local residents

It’s a huge burden that country communities are shouldering compared to the cities and it only looks set to increase with the energy needs of data centres.

And for city people it’s too often a case of out of sight, out of mind.

ACEREZ gets away with it because this is a NSW Government project.

Welcome to the Wild West where it’s one rule for Government and another rule for everyone else.

CENSUS is on Tuesday, 11 August!

The Census gives us a vital snapshot of our nation and helps plan for essential services like local roads, schools, healthcare, and community infrastructure right across our region.

How to complete it:

Households will receive instructions in the mail on how to complete the Census online.

PLEASE NOTE: You will not receive a paper form in the mail, unless you specifically request one.

If you know where you’ll be on Census night, you can complete it as soon as your instructions arrive.

Everyone in Australia is required to participate in the Census. Need Help?

The Census is run directly by the Australian Bureau of Statistics (ABS), our electorate offices cannot access individual records and do not have paper forms.

For help, paper form requests, or general enquiries, please reach out to the ABS directly:

ABS Census Inquiry Service: 1800 181 227

Online: census.abs.gov.au

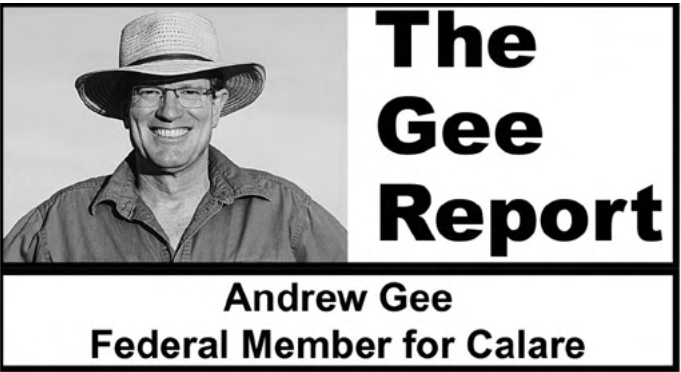
Price Pain at the Pump Returns

With the fuel excise cut now over, petrol prices are going to surge to even higher levels.

This is a massive issue for country people who have to travel far greater distances than those in the cities.

I’m calling on the Federal Government to:

Immediately slash the fuel tax; and Pass my Fair Fuel Price Bill



which would bring back federal fuel price controls like we had during World War Two.

Skyrocketing fuel prices combined with the closure of the Great Western Highway are strangling the economic life out of our region and the government needs to act with urgency.

GRANTS

In a Good Place – Round 12

Supporting initiatives that improve mental health and wellbeing in rural communities and among farmers and farming families.

Applications close: 18 August 2026, 5.00 pm AEST

Apply: <https://frrr.org.au/funding/in-a-good-place/>

Strengthening Rural Communities (SRC) – Round 30

Small and Vital Grants and Prepare and Recover Grants are available to support community-led projects that strengthen local communities and build resilience.

Applications close: 17 September 2026, 5.00 pm AEST

Apply: <https://frrr.org.au/funding/strengthening-rural-communities/>





with **Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld**



MY MUM passed away more than seven years ago.

Ask anyone in our family or among her friends and they’ll all tell you the same thing - she never went anywhere without a camera.

Long before smartphones made photographers of us all, Mum was documenting birthdays, holidays, school concerts and those ordinary moments that somehow become priceless years later.

When we sorted through her belongings, we found shelves of mini photo albums. Holidays, grandchildren and family milestones had separate collections.

It was surprisingly easy to share them around and different family members could walk away with a tangible piece of family history.

Fast forward to my own photographic collection and the picture looks very different... excuse the pun.

I have digital photos and videos stretching back to the nineties. They’re stored on computers, backed up to external hard drives,

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replicated to cloud servers and duplicated in multiple locations. If something failed tomorrow, I’m confident I could recover everything.

But what if it wasn’t me trying to retrieve those memories? What if one day someone else had to find them? Would they know where to look? Would they even know they existed?

The sheer scale of our digital lives is extraordinary.

Society now takes more photographs in a single year than humanity captured during the entire history of photography before the year 2000.

The reason is simple. Every press of Mum’s shutter button cost money.

You bought the film, decided whether the moment was worth capturing, then paid again to have it developed.

Today we can fire off 50 photos of the family dog trying to catch a tennis ball without giving it a second thought.

We’ve gone from making every photo count to counting every photo.

The downside is that our family history no longer lives neatly inside an album on a bookshelf. It’s scattered across phones, laptops, tablets, cloud services and online accounts, often protected by passwords that only one person knows.

Our “personal effects” have quietly changed. They are no longer just jewellery, furniture and boxes in the garage.

Much of our life now exists digitally - photos, videos, documents and decades of memories locked behind a login screen.

That’s why more people are beginning to think about a digital legacy.

Many of the major technology companies now allow you to nominate a trusted person to access your account after you die.

Apple has a Legacy Contact feature, while Google offers its Inactive Account Manager, allowing you to decide what should happen if your account sits unused for a period of time. It’s one of those settings most of us scroll straight past, but perhaps it’s one of the most important.

It’s also becoming more common for

people to appoint a Digital Executor in their will. Their job extends well beyond preserving treasured family photos.

They can archive important files, close online accounts, stop subscriptions, transfer digital assets and ensure your online life is managed according to your wishes.

It’s a role that simply didn’t exist a generation ago.

Looking ahead, I suspect artificial intelligence will become our family’s digital historian. Instead of leaving behind thousands of random files, AI will organise them into stories, identify the people in them, remove blurry shots, add context and perhaps even narrate the history of our families for generations yet to come.

Technology has made it wonderfully easy to record our lives. In fact, we’re documenting ourselves more thoroughly than any generation in history.

Perhaps the greatest irony of the digital age is this: we’ve become experts at capturing moments, yet we’re only just learning how to leave them behind.



YEOVAL EAGLES
first grade prop
Bill Edwards
played his 300th
game in the Minor
Semi-Finals of the
Oilsplus Cup
competition last
Saturday in a home
game.
Now the Eagles
take on Coolah
Roos in the Prelim-
inary Final.



Appeal for information over suspicious fire

POLICE ARE appealing for information follow-
ing a suspicious fire at a storefront in Wellington.
About 3am Tuesday morning an off-duty police
officer attached to Orana Mid Western Police
District observed a building fire at a storefront on
Lee Street.
Police immediately notified Fire and Rescue
NSW, who attended a short time later.
A resident of the premises – a woman in her 20s
– who was asleep at the time, woke and
extinguished the flames, which had damaged the
store’s front door and an area of the floor.
The woman was treated by NSW Ambulance
paramedics and taken to Wellington Hospital for
treatment of minor smoke inhalation.
A crime scene was established.
As investigations continue, police would like to
speak with a man who they believe may be able to
assist with their inquiries.
He is described as wearing full black clothing, a
black backpack, a face covering and helmet, and
was last seen riding a blue and white dirtbike at
the location before fleeing south onto Lee Street
and Warne Street.
Police are urging anyone with information about
this incident – including mobile phone/dashcam
or CCTV footage that relates – to contact
Wellington Police Station or Crime Stoppers on
1800 333 000.

Buddhist Centre working bee this Sunday



THARPA CHOELING - Wellington Buddhist
Centre is conducting a Winter Working Bee this
Sunday, August 9.
Pop in any time during the day from 9am
onwards to help out with paving around the rose
garden, weeding and raking, lots of light activities
in the garden, plus refreshments provided.

**Your sport can record results
in the “Sport” section**
Just contact:
mark@wdleader.news

Wellington & District
LEADER

Check out our
website



Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

Runs on the Board for the Wellington Area

- ✓ \$9.5 million to build a new, purpose built wing focused on dementia and palliative care at Maranatha House
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library’s outdoor reading room



✓ \$12 million in disaster funding for the Duke of Wellington Bridge

Water Delivery

Domestic Water Deliveries
Servicing Wellington Region

Fiona: 0427 463 441 Ken: 0427 463 442

Your sport can record results
in the “Sport” section.

Just contact: mark@wdleader.news

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington

WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering

MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church

77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church

Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
5pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month

Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Commemorating 110th anniversary of Australia’s first and most significant battle on the Western Front

A COMMEMORATIVE service marking the 110th anniversary of one of the most significant combats in Australia’s military history was held at the Anzac Memorial in Hyde Park.

The commemoration honoured the courage, sacrifice and service of the Australian soldiers who fought in the Battle of Fromelles on 19 and 20 July 1916 in northern France, the first major engagement undertaken by our diggers on the Western Front during the First World War.

Attended by veterans, descendants, community representatives and members of the public, the ceremony provided an opportunity for reflection and remembrance.

In less than 24 hours of fighting, more than 6000 Australian soldiers were killed, wounded or captured during the battle, making it one of the costliest days in our nation’s military history.

Of the Australian soldiers involved 1813 were killed during combat, 252 later died of wounds, more than 3500 were wounded and 479 taken prisoner.

One of those wounded was Sydneysider Private John Thompson who received a severe gunshot wound to his left shoulder serving in the 53rd Battalion during the battle.

Private Thompson spent the night in no-man’s-land before being rescued by his fellow diggers and spent the rest of the war recovering in hospitals in

England.

His great grandson Michael Smith retells that Private Thompson returned to Sydney in 1919 where he met his son - Michael’s grandfather - for the first time and never had the full use of his left arm again.

Starting with a Commemorative Procession from the Archibald Fountain, the service continued in the Auditorium and included a special Star Ceremony in the Anzac Memorial’s Hall of Memory.

The Anzac Memorial has a number of collection items from the Battle of Fromelles, which can be viewed on the Memorial’s Collection website: <https://collection.anzacmemorial.nsw.gov.au/highlights/fromelles/objects>



Audrey recognised for her cup cake fundraising skills

State Member for Dubbo and Wellington called into Jespresso Café recently to personally thank Audrey Burfitt for her cup cake fundraising efforts.

Copy of Hansard report from Parliament.

Speaker, I would like to acknowledge seven-year-old Audrey Burfitt who recently held an Easter charity cupcake sale in her community of Wellington.

Through her wonderful initiative, Audrey not only showcased her baking talents and emerging entrepreneurial spirit but her commitment to helping others.

Her efforts raised more than fifteen hundred dollars, which she generously donated to Jeff Amatto’s Darrambal Program.

The Darrambal Program is a school-based initiative dedicated to connecting students with their

cultural heritage, with the goal of strengthening engagement, improving attendance, and supporting positive educational outcomes.

Audrey’s contribution will make a meaningful difference in the lives of young people.

While Audrey may be just seven years of age, she displays a level of generosity, compassion and community awareness beyond her years.

This is the second year Audrey has organised a cupcake sale for charity, and her continued commitment highlights her genuine desire to give back to her community.

Audrey should be incredibly proud of her efforts and the positive impact she is making.

Well done, Audrey!

Around the electorate with our State Member Dugald Saunders

Census sessions

THE 2026 Census will take place on Tuesday, August 11.

While the Census is run by the Australian Bureau of Statistics on behalf of the Federal Government, from my perspective as a State MP, it’s hugely important to show what regional areas like ours, need for the future.

It tracks how communities are changing and helps guide some of the funding required for public services. It’s also important from an infrastructure planning perspective, as everything from schools and hospitals to roads and local facilities rely on accurate data provided by the Census.

Households across Australia will receive a letter in the mail with instructions to complete the Census online, while others will receive a paper form or visit from a Census field officer.

If you, your, family or someone you support has questions about completing the 2026 Census or would like assistance, the Dubbo Census Team will be available to help at:

* Woolworths at Orana Mall – Thursday 6

August, Friday 7 August and Saturday 8 August from 10am to 6pm

* Spotlight – Thursday 13 August from 11am to 4pm

* Uniting Aboriginal Fathers Group – Friday 14 August from 10am to 2pm

* Bunnings – Saturday 15 August from 11am to 4pm

Make sure to bring your instruction letter or paper Census form if you attend one of these sessions.

Blue Plaque Trail

NSW’s first Blue Plaque Trail has been extended to commemorate more stops of the 1965 Freedom Ride, a landmark civil rights journey through regional NSW that played an instrumental role in building momentum for reconciliation action in Australia.

Blue Plaques in Dubbo, Gulargambone, Moree, Boggabilla, Bowraville and Kempsey now join the existing plaques at Wayside Chapel in Sydney and the Freedom Ride Memorial Park in Walgett to create a Trail that invites visitors to retrace the journey and discover the stories, people and

events of the Freedom Ride.

The Trail’s route was developed with the input of more than 100 community members and organisations, who helped identify the towns and significant locations to be recognised with Blue Plaques.

For more information, including a map, visit: environment.nsw.gov.au/topics/heritage/blue-plaques/1965-freedom-ride

Cancer conversation

Cancer Council NSW is inviting community members aged 40-70 to join a conversation about screening for breast, bowel and cervical cancer.

Participants will be asked to share their experiences and ideas about screening for these cancers in a 90-minute session, to help Cancer Council understand what makes cancer screening easier for regional communities to access and to identify the barriers.

You do not need to have experience with cancer screening to participate.

For more information or to register your interest in participating, email

screening@nswcc.org.au or call 02 9334 1360.

Sign the Petition

We need more overtaking lanes between Wellington and Dubbo, and there’s currently a petition open calling for just that.

To make it easier for locals to sign the petition, the following businesses are kindly displaying a QR code which links directly to the petition website:

* PitStop Garage Geurie
* The Lemon Tree Café
* Geurie General Store
* Ron Stubberfield Toyota
* Jespresso Coffee Co.
* Cusacks Butchery
* Wellington Lions Pre-loved Book Store

You can also sign the petition by following the prompts on my Facebook and Instagram pages or my website at www.dugaldsaunders.com.au

Until next time,
Dugald

2026 Wellington Eisteddfod Results

Tuesday 28 and Wednesday 29 July, 2026. - Music Program

M001 Beginners -10 years and Under PIANO - SOLO Junior
Lessons for 18 months or less
1 Sophie Finn, Wellinton; 2 Camilla Holland, Wellington; 3 Eva Spradbrow, Wellington
HC Elsie Gain, Geurie.

M002 8 Years & Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Skylar James; 2 Camilla Holland, Wltn.

M003 9 years & under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Bella Hartsuyker; 2 Annabel Holland, Wltn; 3 Summer Whillock, Wltn; 4 Elsie Gain, Wltn.

M004 10 years & Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Sophie Finn, Wltn.

M005 11 years and Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Sylvie Laurie, Wltn; 2 Polly Whillock, Wltn; 3 Cameron Lewis.

M006 12 years & Under PIANO SOLO Junior
1 Izabel Denison.

M010 Preliminary GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Elsie Gain, Wltn.

M011 1st Grade GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Sylvie Laurie, Wltn; 2 Bella Hartsuyker.

M013 3rd & 4th Grades GRADED PIANO SOLO Any Age
1 Izabel Denison; 2 Cameron Lewis.

M018 10 years and Under MODERN PIANO SOLO Junior
Popular, Blues, Boogie, Jazz, Rock etc
1 Bella Hartsuyker; 2 Annabel Holland; 3 Eva Spradbrow, Wltn; 4 Summer Whillock, Wltn.

M019 11 and 12 years only MODERN PIANO SOLO Junior
Popular, Blues, Boogie, Jazz, Rock etc
1 Izabel Denison; 2 Cameron Lewis; 3 Sylvie Laurie, Wltn.

M022 12 years & Under BAROQUE PIANO SOLO Junior
Music from the c.1600 to c. 1750
1 Cameron Lewis.

M025 10 years and Under STRING SOLO Junior
Violin,Viola, Cello, Double Bass
1 Ella Holland, Wltn; 2

M026 12 years and Under STRING SOLO Junior
Violin,Viola, Cello, Double Bass
1 Erin Pearson

M029 Preliminary & 1st Grade GRADED STRING SOLO Any Age
Violin,Viola, Cello, Double Bass
1 Ella Holland, Wtn; 2 Erin Pearson

M034 Open STRING DUO/TRIO Any Age
Accompaniment Optional
1 Ella Hollland, Jess Holland & Alison Williams, Wltn; 2. Jessica Holland & Alison Williams, Wltn.

M044 12 years and Under WOODWIND SOLO Junior
Piccolo, Flute, Oboe, Clarinet, Saxophone, Bassoon, Recorder
1 Caylee Johnston, Wltn.

M045 15 years and Under WOODWIND SOLO Intermediate/Senior
Piccolo, Flute, Oboe, Clarinet, Saxophone, Bassoon, Recorder
1 Annabel Roberts, Wltn; 2 Julia Nicholson, Wtn; 3 Ariana Johnston, Wltn.

M049 5th, 6th, 7th and 8th Grades GRADED WOODWIND SOLO Any Age
Piccolo, Flute, Oboe, Clarinet, Saxophone, Bassoon, Recorder
1 Julia Nicholson, Wltn.

M056 12 years and Under BRASS INSTRUMENTAL SOLO Junior
Cornet, Trumpet, French Horn, Tenor Horn, Trombone, Baritone, Euphonium, Tuba
1 Charlee Clavell, Wltn.

M079 6 years and Under Nursery Rhyme in Costume VOCAL SOLO Junior
Microphone
1 Maisie Whillock, Wltn.

M080 12 years and Under Vocal Solo
1 Rupert Comiskey, Wltn.

M081 13 to 16 years VOCAL SOLO Intermediate/Senior
Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox; 2 Amelia Williams

M082 13 to 16 years VOCAL - POPULAR, ROCK, BLUES OR JAZZ SOLO
Intermediate/Senior Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox
2 Madeline Flannery

M083 13 to 16 years VOCAL - MUSICAL THEATRE OR OPERETTA SOLO
Intermediate/Senior
Costume + Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox

M084 Open VOCAL - MUSICAL THEATRE OR OPERETTA SOLO Any Age
Costume + Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox

M085 Open VOCAL - POPULAR, ROCK, BLUES OR JAZZ SOLO Any Age
excluding Musical Theatre + Microphone Optional
1 Scarlett Fox

M087 Open VOCAL - ART SONG SOLO Any Age
Art Song
1 Scarlett Fox

M090 12 years and Under VOCAL - BEGINNERS SOLO Junior
Lessons for 18 months or less + Microphone Optional
1 Amelia Williams

M092 12 years and Under VOCAL DUO/TRIO Junior
Microphone Optional
1 Greta Comiskey & Summer Whillock, Wltn.

M065 Infants (Kindergarten - 2) PERCUSSION BANDS GROUP Junior
May use body percussion and competitors can enter multiple times.
1 Wellington Public School Kindergarten.

M065.1 Pre-School or Daycare Percussion Band
1 Wellington Public Preschool; 2 Wellington Family Daycare.

Primary Percussion Band
1 Parkes East Public School.

M095 Special Needs Choir SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Any Age
May sing one or two songs
1 Yawarra Community School; 2 Wellington Public School.

M096 Kindergarten, Years 1 and 2 SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Junior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Wellington Public School - Stage 1

M097 Primary SCHOOL CHOIR - years 3 and 4 SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Junior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Wellington Public School Stage 2

M098 Primary SCHOOL CHOIR - years 5 and 6 SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Junior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Gulgong Public School; 2Wellington Public School - Stage 3

M100 Secondary School Choir SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Intermediate/Senior
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 St Mary’s Catholic School Yr 7 & Yr 8, Wtn.

M101 School Singing Choir SCHOOL CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Two Contrasting Songs of Choice
1 Saint John’s Primary, Dubbo

M102 Open Choir Group OPEN CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Two songs of choice - any arrangement
1 Stray Notes SATB Choir;, Wtn 2 Stray Notes Ladies Choir, Wltn.

M104 Open - Sacred Song OPEN CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Two songs of choice - any arrangement
1 Stray Notes Ladies Choir, Wtn; 2 Stray Notes SATB Choir, Wltn.

M105 Open -Popular; Show/Barbershop Chorus OPEN CHOIR GROUP Any Age
Costume and Choreography Optional
1 Stray Notes SATB Choir

Francis, Whitley and Gibbons Perpetual Trophy for Most Outstanding Performance in Vocal or Instrumental
Parkes East Primary School.

12 years and Under - Junior Local Scholarship
Ella Holland, Wltn.

13 years and Over - Senior Local Scholarship
Annabel Roberts, Wltn.

Best School Choir
St Johns Primary, Dubbo

Best School Percussion Group
Parkes East Primary School

Most Outstanding Junior Pianist
Izabel Denison

Encouragement Award - Junior Pianist
Cameon Lewis

Most Outstanding Junior Instrumentalist
Cameron Lewis

Encouragement Award - Junior Instrumentalist
Sylvie Laurie, Wltn.

Most Outstanding Intermediate Instrumentalist
Julia Nicholson, Wltn.

Encouragement Award - Intermediate Instrumentalist
Izabel Denison

Most Outstanding Senior Instumentalist
Scarlett Fox

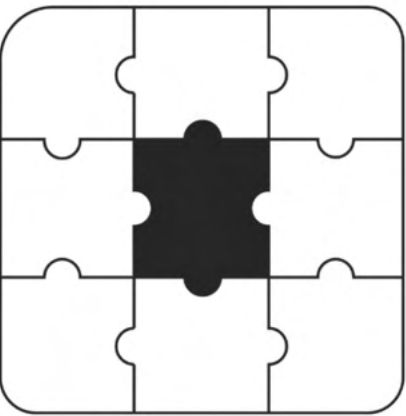
Encouagement Award - Senior Instrumentalist
Amelia Williams

Insert the missing letters to make 10 words – five reading across the grid and five reading down.

B		S		L
	L		D	
A		P		E
	H		E	
H		R		Y

Place each of the tiles of letters into the blank jigsaw below to create four six-letter words going across and down.

ED	DR
SE	OW
GO	AT
ON	OS



There may be more than one possible answer.

Insert each number from 1 to 9 in the shaded squares to solve all the horizontal and vertical equations. Multiplication and division are performed before addition and subtraction.

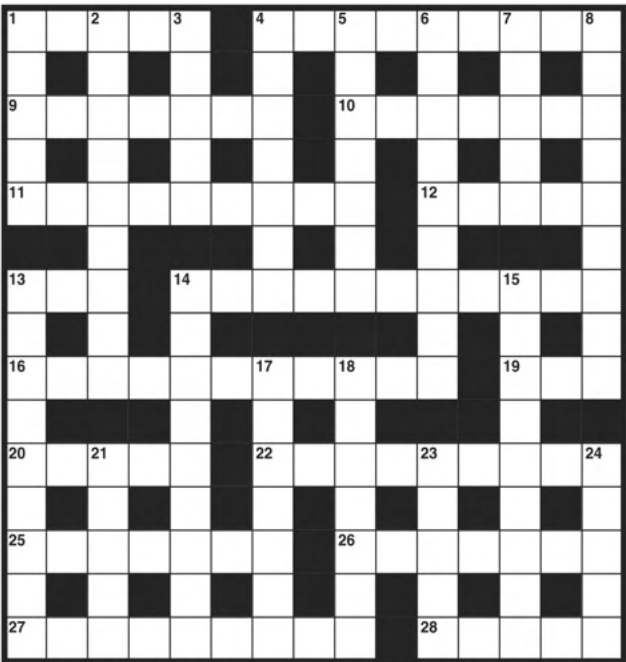
	×		−		=	7
+		+		−		
	+		×		=	33
×		÷		+		
	−		−		=	2
=		=		=		
29		8		8		

EDGECROSSWORD						
Y	A	R	H			
R	E	C	H			
E	P	A				
E	U	E				
L	I	B	A	S		
5x5						
	8		8		629	
	=		=		=	
2	=	4	−	1	−	7
	+		÷		×	
33	=	5	×	9	+	3
	−		+		+	
7	=	9	−	2	×	8
CROSSMATH						

[illegible]

CROSSWORD

No. 190



ACROSS

- 1 Ribbons (5)
4 Enchanted (9)
9 Sooner (7)
10 Burdensome (7)
11 Illicitly distilled liquor (9)
12 Buffalo (5)

- 13 US tech company (1.1.1)
14 Body of water to the East of Italy (8,3)
16 A baptism (11)
19 Hint (3)
20 Varnish (5)
22 Broadening (9)

- 25 Wayne —, coach of the Brisbane Broncos (7)
26 First (7)
27 Substances discharged (9)
28 Hostile (5)

DOWN

- 1 Load-bearing bar structure (1-4)
2 Actor (9)
3 Hides, pelts (5)
4 Obstacle (7)
5 Aboriginal spear-throwing device (7)
6 Quivering (9)
7 Rings (5)
8 Release (9)
13 Terminal (illness) (9)
14 Yes men (9)
15 Offering (9)
17 Dance music style (7)
18 Suggests (7)
21 Egyptian peninsula (5)
23 Din (5)
24 Expression of surprise (coll) (5)

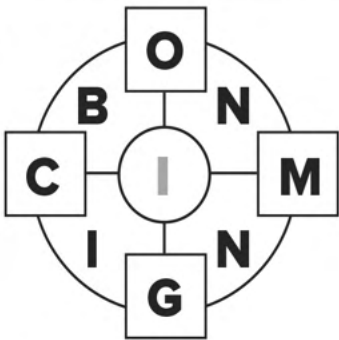


9-LETTER

No. 190

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:
10 words: Good
15 words: Very good
20 words: Excellent

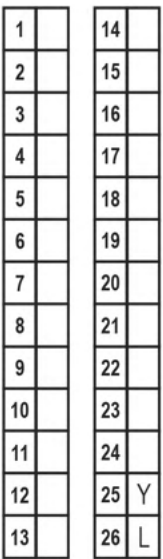
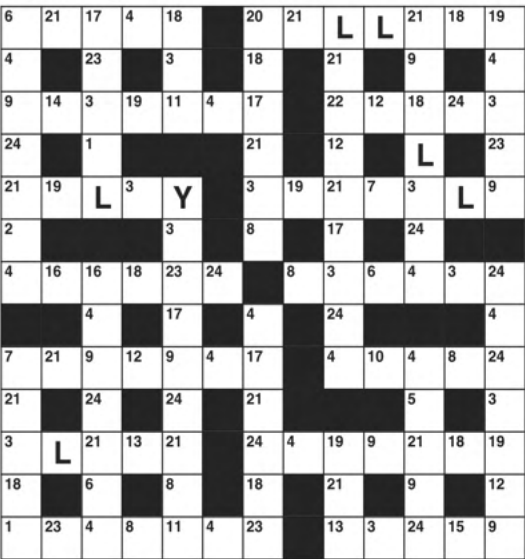


bingo, biontic, boning,
coln, colning, combing,
COMBINING, coming,
coning, gnomic, icing,
icon, incoming, lonic,
mignon, mincing, min,
miling, milion, nimbi

CODEWORD

No. 140

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?

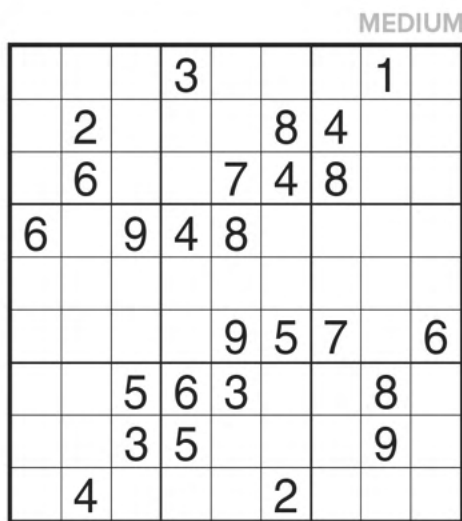
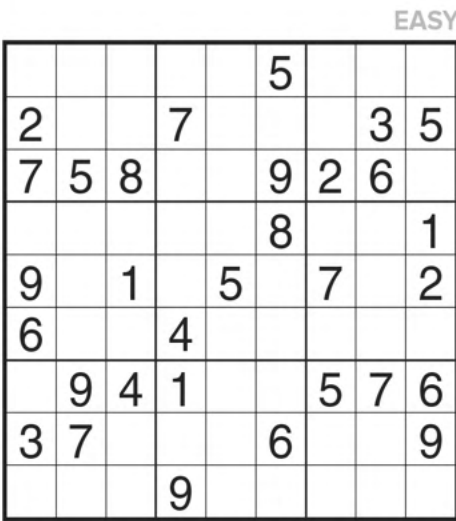


13=B, 14=P, 15=F, 16=D, 17=Z, 18=N, 19=Q, 20=M, 21=V, 22=L, 23=R, 24=T
SOLUTIONS: 1=W, 2=G, 3=A, 4=E, 5=X, 6=V, 7=M, 8=C, 9=S, 10=J, 11=K, 12=U,

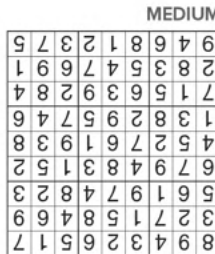
SUDOKU

No. 190

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



WORDFIT

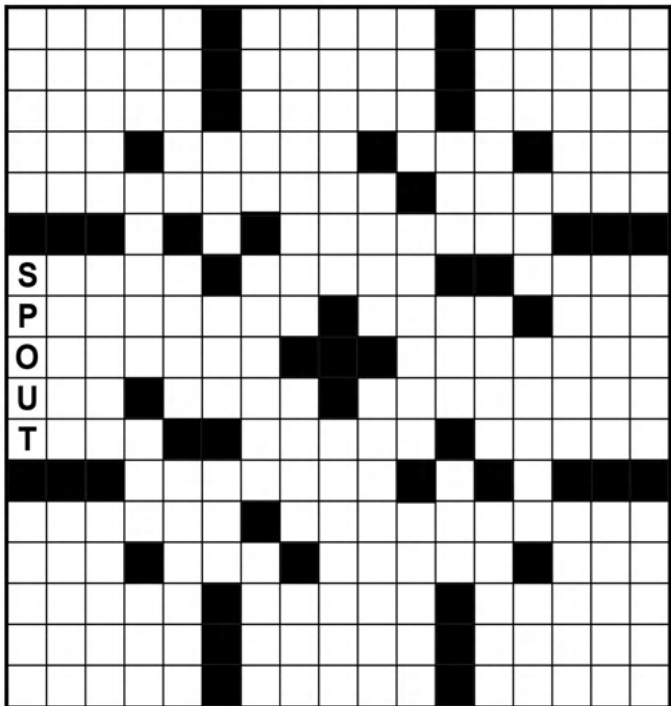
No. 100

3 LETTERS

- ASH
CIA
GNU
HAT
IDS
ILL
ITS
KID
LIE
OUR
ROE
RPM
SEW
SKI
TEA
THE
TOE
TUG
TWO
USE
VAN
WOE

5 LETTERS

- ABETS
ACTED
AGAIN
AMASS
AREN'T
ARISE
AROSE
AURAL
AWARD
BATHE
BOATS
CACTI
CHORE
DELTA
DREGS
EASEL
ENDER
ENROL
FOYER
HALON
HIGHS
ICING
INDEX
IOTAS
MANIA
NINTH
OLDEN
OVERT
PEEVE
REALM
REIGN
REVUE
SAGAS
SENSE



4 LETTERS

- DATE
DUST
EACH
EATS
LAID
NITS
SEED
SINS
TEXT
TOTS

- SHELL
SLEWS
SMELL
SMOTE
SOBER
SPOUT
SPREE
STEEL
STILL
TAPER
TERSE
TOOTH
TRIPE
TRUST

6 LETTERS

- ASPIRE
BATONS
DRAWLS
ENTERS
FOSSIL
IRISES

WEARING

- 8 LETTERS
GARRISON
PAYMENTS
PENTAGON
PLACENTA

10 LETTERS

- LANDLADIES
SEMBLANCES

7 LETTERS

- ACUTELY
ORDAINS
SLEDDED
THEREON
WEALTHY



QUICK QUIZ

- In the 1930s, Nestlé became the first company to produce what kind of chocolate?
- Anya Taylor-Joy (pictured) holds triple citizenship in the US, the UK and which other country?
- The oldest living tree is 4,855 years old and can be found where?
- Which country is blue cheese originally from?
- Which actress plays Dr. Jean Milburn in the series Sex Education?
- Which football club sacked Ange Postecoglou after a 39-day tenure in 2025?
- Which late singer became the first British female artist to win five Grammys in one ceremony?
- Which two F1 drivers currently hold the record for most World Drivers' Championships, at seven titles won each?
- What is the smallest planet in our solar system?
- What is the smallest country in the world?



ANSWERS: 1. White chocolate 2. Argentina 3. California 4. France 5. Gillian Anderson 6. Nottingham Forest 7. Amy Winehouse 8. Michael Schumacher and Lewis Hamilton 9. Mercury 10. Vatican City

WORD SEARCH

No. 100

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- ATLANTIC
BATANG AI
BOSAWÁS
CHUGACH
GONDWANA
KAKADU
KAYAN MENTARANG
KHAO SOK
KINABALU
KING LAKE
LACANDON
MADAGASCAR
MANÚ
MIOMBO
PACIFIC
PAPUA
PERUCICA
SALONGA
SAPO
SEQUOIA
SPRINGBROOK
SUMATRA
TAIGA
TARRA BULGA
TONGASS
TROSSACHS
VIRGIN KOMI

SECRET MESSAGE: The best time to plant a tree is right now

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OUR INSTAGRAM OUR FACEBOOK

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Residential Sales Manager
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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

For More Information call



Mb: 0428 635 994

DRIVING to Dubbo the wattle display is fantastic. Chance of light showers this Sunday. Summing up the outlook for the next seven days - dry and cold.

Preparing your herd for Calving season

Calving is one of the most rewarding times of the year, but it's also one of the most demanding.

With more than 70% of foetal growth occurring during the final two months of pregnancy nutritional demands increase rapidly, making this one of the most important times to ensure cows are receiving adequate nutrition.

MAGNESIUM - is one of the most critical minerals to consider during the lead up to calving. Across many southern grazing regions, high potassium fertiliser applications combined with cool, wet conditions and reduced sunlight, can reduce the amount of magnesium available to grazing livestock.

This may increase the risk of hypomagnesemia (grass tetany) and can also contribute to milk fever around calving. Magnesium also plays an essential role in helping cows mobilise calcium from their bones and body reserves during late pregnancy and early lactation, supporting normal muscle function and helping maintain adequate blood calcium levels when demand is highest.

UNDERSTANDING CALCIUM - before calving. A common misconception is that feeding large amounts of calcium immediately before calving will help prevent milk fever. In reality, cows need to activate their natural calcium mobilisation mechanisms before calving. If blood calcium remains consistently high right up until calving, these systems may not be fully primed when calcium demand suddenly increases after birth. These minerals are available in block form also.

Markets at a Glance

WOOL.. The market is in a three-week mid-year recess. Sales will recommence in the week of Monday, August 17.

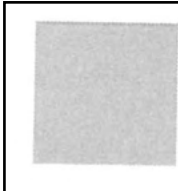
CATTLE CTLX. 28th. 2149 head -433. Plenty of feeder steers and heifers, limited young trade cattle, heavy grown heifers better supplied, grown steers and bullocks limited, 450 cows. The market sold cheaper. Weaner steers back 10c to 624c, heifers to 538c/kg. Medium feeder steers dropped 13c, heavy weights 5c. Bulk of feeders 500c and 586c/kg. Feeder heifers firm to 5c cheaper, 460c to 540c/kg. Young trade cattle back 20c, steers to 510c/kg. Grown steers and heifers lost 15 c to 20c/kg, steers and bullocks 450c and 460c, heavy heifers 420c to 450c/kg. Cows back 3c to 6c, heavy 4 score-cows 388c to 420c/kg, 2-score cows to process 323c to 355c/kg. Restockers paid 379c to 393c/kg for the larger frame cows.

SHEEP CTLX 29th. 1625 sheep +225, 2825 lambs -3375. Lamb supply halved. Quality good for supplementary fed lambs, remainder lacked finish. A few trade weight new season lambs \$272 to \$310, ave 1270c to 1305c/kg cwt. Medium and heavy trade old lambs firm to \$7 dearer. Heavy trade \$274 to \$300.. Larger lots of light trade Merino lambs around \$220. Heavy lambs \$3 to \$10 dearer, \$298 to \$322, extra heavies \$315 to \$375.50.

MUTTON. Prices \$6 stronger. Heavy first-cross ewes \$200 to \$330.

STOCK CLEARANCE continues.

Give us a ring for pricing.



Ray White

RICHARDSON AND SINCLAIR

Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE.. 2835 head. More good numbers of young cattle for restockers and feeders. Some top lines of cows, odd pens well finished grown steers and heifers. Young trade cattle 14c cheaper, vealers and yearlings 435c to 530c/kg. Light feeder steers and heifers close to firm, heavier feeder steers up to 20c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 494c to 590c, heifers 440c to 550c/kg. Young cattle to restockers up to 30c cheaper, steers 400c to 609c, heifers to 530c/kg. Grown steers and heifers firm, steers 425c to 488c/kg, heifers 420c to 470c/kg. Secondary cows firm to 5c cheaper, heavy cows 8c/kg dearer. 2 and 3 score cows to processors 330c to 400c, heavy cows 393c to 429c, ave 412c/kg. Cows to restockers 280c to 408c/kg. Heavy bulls to 440c/kg.

DUBBO SHEEP.. 16,100 lambs. Fair numbers of well finished heavy and

trade lambs, and secondary plainer lambs. Not all buyers operating in a fluctuating market. Trade lambs \$12 cheaper, 20kg to 24kg \$228 to \$295, ave 1110c to 1175c/kg cwt. Trade new season lambs \$250 to \$283. Heavy lambs finished firm, 24kg to 30kg \$274 to \$343, ave 1150c/kg cwt. Over 30kg \$336 to \$359. Trade Merino lambs firm to \$6 cheaper, heavies \$11 cheaper. Trade Merinos \$180 to \$292, heavies \$280 to \$320. Crossbred and exotic lambs to restockers up to \$20 cheaper, \$130 to \$278. Merino lambs to restockers \$77 to \$170. Hoggets to \$298.

MUTTON.. 6600 head. Most grades were up to \$25 cheaper. Merino ewes \$93 to \$278, crossbred ewes \$140 to \$283. Merino wethers \$107 to \$250, crossbred wethers to \$298. Most sheep ranged from 770c to 810c/kg cwt.

NO WOOL SALE last week.

Racing at Dubbo 130726

THE DECISION by local trainer Todd Smith to step Godwits up in distance proved the right one when the four-year-old gelding outstayed the opposition in the 2200 metres Elders Rural Benchmark 58 Handicap on Monday, July 13 at Dubbo.

Very well ridden by Dubbo jockey Liam Blanch, Godwits (\$16) had a slender lead over Bill Peyto leaving the back before racing away in the straight to win by nearly three lengths from Think I'm Irish (Jenny Duggan, \$7) and the \$3.10 favourite Farraige (Damon Budler).

Todd Smith, who received his trainers licence only this year, has taken Godwits from a 1400 win at Quambone Picnics to winning a stayers race at a Dubbo TAB meeting.

Sam Fitzgerald, a former manager of Dubbo Turf Club and now the racing manager for high profile trainer Ciaron Maher, explained after the win that Godwits is a half-brother to the Maher trained Skua.

A rising three-year-old, Skua has started once for a second placing over 1300m at Newcastle in March and according to Sam Fitzgerald, the Maher stable is hoping the colt can develop in to a good stayer.

Liam Blanch completed a double with another good ride, on Palentino Swinger in the 1100m XXXX Ultra-Country Boosted Benchmark 58 Handicap.

The five-year-old mare Palentino Swinger had good form against strong Maiden fields when previously in work including a win at Tamworth following placings in big fields at Dubbo and Narromine before being spelled after seven starts.

Roaming a paddock for nearly two years, Palentino Swinger was recently purchased for a bargain price by Dubbo trainer Janelle Galea and

her family and friends and put back in work.

Considering the past good form and despite an unplaced run when resuming, Palentino Swinger was at surprisingly long odds (\$51) and the rank outsider in the field when coming from last with a rails run to beat the topweight Street Parade (Jasmine Urwahart-Warren, \$4.40) and Tiye (Zoe Hunt, \$7.50).

Backing up from a win at Cowra two days prior to Dubbo, Moonzone was again a strong finishing winner for local trainer Clint Lundholm, in the XXXX Gold Benchmark 58 Handicap.

Kody Nestor rode Moonzone at Cowra, however the Lundholm stable apprentice Zoe Hunt had the mount at Dubbo and she produced a well-judged ride, bringing Moonzone from back in the field to beat Fierce Luva (Izzy Neale, \$31) and Honey Slider (Liam Blanch, \$18) in a close finish.

Kody Nestor now has a dual licence and the four-year-old mare Lady Lilibet which he trains at Dubbo, won the 1600m Stone & Wood Maiden Handicap.

Jake Pracey-Holmes rode Miss Lilibet (\$4.40) with great vigour and after a tremendous battle with powerful rider Clayton Gallagher on Adamana (\$1.95 to \$1.75 fav), Miss Lilibet won by a head with Sonnig (Damon Budler (\$5) a half-length away third.

The Bob Howe, Mudgee trained Torendosetta (Jasmine Urwahart-Warren, \$6) made it successive wins when claiming the lead in the closing stages to win the 1100m Marty Nelson Refrigeration & Air Conditioning -BM 58 Handicap by a half-length from Glowing Rapids (Jess Del Frari, \$8.50) and De Joker (Jacob Stiff, \$3.70 fav).

Wellington Race Club

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Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Gilgandra – Collie Cup – Tooraweenah Cup

RESILIENT GALLOPER Castlebar Road added another feature race to the record when winning the 1280 metres Three Rivers Machinery - Collie Cup before a very good crowd on Saturday at Gilgandra.

Owned by Harry Barclay from Warren and trained at Mendooran by Jane Clement, the 10-year-old gelding Castlebar Road (\$4.20) was taken straight to the lead by the in-form apprentice Gabrielle Johnston and in the final stages held off by a head Shaggy Rogers (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$8) with Delrico (Heavalon Van Der Hoven, \$11) a half-length away third.

Castlebar Road has now won nine races and been placed 10 times with the previous win to Gilgandra being the Cannonball at Warren in mid-June.

Landing some good bets for supporters was the Peter Reynolds, Dubbo trained Loud in the 1100m Hair & Beauty & Keith Kilby Memorial Benchmark 50 Handicap.

Backed from \$7 to \$4.60, Loud (Heavalon Van Der Hoven) took the lead from Notabadchassis and fought on well to beat Roman Miss (Clayton Gallagher, \$6.50) and Powderfinger (Nick Palmer, \$14).

A winner at Come-By-Picnics last campaign, the Joe Hodgson, Coonamble trained Ilikesoo boogie (Leanne Boyd, \$18) resuming from a spell, led for home and staved off Beaunified (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$8) and Angie's Sister (Jasmine Urqahart-Warren, \$1.50) in a close finish to the 800m Western Farm Machinery-B & C Cooxsedge Memorial Benchmark 50 Handicap.

After a previous washout, the 1600m Mountain View Hotel-Tooraweenah Cup was run on Saturday and Himeros (Juliet Partridge, \$5) trained at Narromine by Kylie Kennedy for Warwick Harper, led and in a close finish won from Snow Dog (Hollie Hull, \$11) and Wayne To Divine (Jasmine Urqahart-Warren, \$13).

Even closer was the finish to the 1100m Gilgandra Toyota-Jockeys Celebration Day BM 50 Handicap when the Dean Mirfin, Bathurst trained Lady Giovanna, \$3.20 fav) lasted to beat the fast-finishing Rivaldo (Juliet Partridge, \$7.50) by a nose with Tesorino (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$5) a short-half-head away third.

From the John Bannister stable at Muswellbrook, Poised (Jasmine Urqahart-Warren, \$2.25) tracked the leaders then finished best for a half-length win over Mega Pixel (Gabrielle Johnston, \$2.10 to \$1.80 fav) and Summer Sonata (Liam Blanch, \$51) in the Chandler Chaff & M & M Brophy Memorial Maiden Handicap.

Racing at Louth on Saturday followed by Dubbo on Monday, August 10 and Wellington, Thursday, August10.

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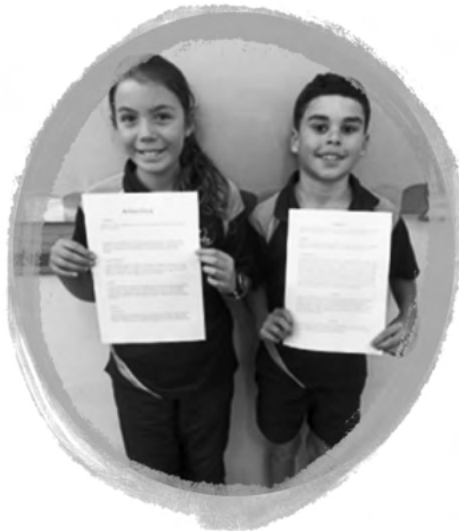
📍 Percy Street, Wellington NSW 2820

✉ wellington-p.schools@det.nsw.edu.au



STAGE 2

In Term 2, Stage 2 students participated in a learning unit focused on Antarctica. The aim was to build students' knowledge about a unique environment and develop their skills in writing informative texts. Stage 2 students learned about Antarctica through a variety of quality texts, which fostered their understanding of the continent and enhanced their ability to write informative reports.



A wonderful showcase of our Stage 2 choir occurred on Tuesday at our local Wellington Eisteddfod. Well done to our beautiful singers in Stage 2.





St Mary's Catholic School

37 Percy St Wellington NSW 2820

Ph: (02) 68451822

www.stmaryswellington.catholic.edu.au



St Mary's Kindergarten Celebrates 100 Days

St Mary's Kindergarten students recently celebrated an exciting milestone, marking 100 wonderful days of learning, growing and making memories together.

The classroom was filled with smiles, creativity and plenty of energy as students embraced the special day with a range of fun activities. Dressed in creative outfits celebrating being "brighter, wiser, older and smarter", the students certainly looked the part! The celebrations continued with 100 biscuit decorating and 100 snack mix activities, giving students the opportunity to practise their counting skills while creating some delicious treats.

Kindergarten also enjoyed special buddy time with Year 6 students, who visited to share the celebration and present their younger buddies with beautiful handmade cards.

It was a wonderful opportunity to celebrate how much our Kindergarten students have grown and learned during their first 100 days of school. Congratulations, Kindergarten!



Wellington Warriors providing pathways for young footballers

CONTINUING TO invest in the future of local football, the Wellington Warriors Football Club is providing young players with opportunities to develop their skills through its Development Program.

The Warriors take great pride in nurturing local talent and offering children who are eager to challenge themselves the chance to play competitive football against teams from across the Dubbo and District Football Association.

In 2026, the club has proudly fielded three development teams in the Under 7s, Under 10s and Under 12s competitions.

Each team is supported by a dedicated coach and manager who work tirelessly to create a positive, encouraging environment where players can build confidence, improve their skills and develop a love for the game.

Leading the teams this season are coaches Jane Pearce, Kathryn King and Dave Grant, supported by managers Jess Chown, Katrina Gersbach and Tarni Hawkins.

Together, they bring many years of football knowledge and experience, providing invaluable guidance and mentorship to the club’s young players.

Their commitment, passion and willingness to volunteer their time ensure every child has the opportunity to learn, grow and enjoy the game in a supportive environment.

The Development Program follows a home-and-away format, with teams playing at Pioneer Park one week before travelling to Dubbo the following week.

This provides players with valuable experience competing against a wide range of opposition while exposing them to a higher standard of football that encourages continued growth and development.

The program is about far more than winning matches. It focuses on teamwork, sportsmanship, resilience and personal growth, while giving young players the opportunity to test themselves in a more competitive environment.

The experience gained each week helps build stronger footballers and more confident young people, both on and off the field.

The Wellington Warriors are proud to provide a clear pathway for local players who wish to continue developing their football journey, ensuring country children have access to quality coaching and competitive opportunities without leaving their community.

The club is incredibly grateful for the dedication of its volunteer coaches, managers and families, whose ongoing support makes the Development Program possible.

As the season progresses, the Wellington Warriors look forward to watching their young players continue to develop their skills, represent their town with pride and inspire the next generation of Warriors.

Jess Chown



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Wellington & District
LEADER



Warriors Soccer last weekend

Jo Ivey photos



Redbacks last weekend

Carmen Gain photos



Golfing News

Rodney McMahon and Rod Miller August medal winners

AUGUST monthly medals were up for grabs last Saturday with Rodney McMahon tallying a 72nett to win A Grade while Paul West was runner-up with 73nett.

B grade winner was Rod Miller who finished with a 73nett and just one behind was Cuddy Conn who became runner-up on a countback with 74nett.

The George Hollow Putting Competition winner was Mathew Reid with 24putts.

Prize winners were Ashley Bullock, Paul Hannelly 74netts; Daniel McCullum 76nett; Elton Keeffe, Richard Agar 77netts; Malcolm Payne, James Armstrong 78netts; Peter Payne 79nett on c/b.

Nearest the pin on 3rd Paul West, 8th Brad Conn, 14th John Gersbach, 16th Richard Agar.

NTP in two shots on the 7th was Brad Conn.

Longest drives on the 13th went to Mathew Conn in A grade and in B grade it went to Zac McManus.

The Brent Eather Encouragement award was hotly contested with plenty of big scores put forward by some supposably good golfers, but in the end, it was taken out by Ryan McCracken who put together a score he will probably want to forget, final score 92nett.

Congratulations to the Ladies on their great Pennants win a couple of weeks ago, they came home with four matches to one win and are now awaiting their next rivals.

August 9 is the date of the Golf Club's Mixed Foursomes, sponsored by Robert Baker with Cheryl and Norm Royal.

More information to follow.

The Club Advisory Committee is clamping down on slow play, plus those golfers not repairing their divots or pitch marks and those destroying the tee markers.

Please stop and take more care.

It's becoming very expensive to keep on buying these.

Also if players have accidentally put a NTP marker in their golf bag, please return it as the Club has a shortage at the moment.

Wednesday's Two-Person Ambrose was brilliantly played by Noella Baker and Marie Cornish to come away with a 69.25nett win.

Runners-up were Jannelle Frappell and Marg Hollow on a c/b with 70nett.

NTPs, Wendy Slack-Smith and Kate Charlton.

Thursday's Individual Stableford winner was Steven McCarroll who cleaned the field up with 39pts.

Runner-up was Kurt Cusack who finished with 35pts on a c/b.

Prize winners James Armstrong 35pts; Paul West 33pts; Rod McMahon 32pts; Rex England 31pts.

Diggers Golf 4Ball Aggregate Stroke winners were Renee Wykes and Neale McCabe who won the event on a count-back with 71nett.

Runners-up were Kathy Martin and Peter Holden also with 71nett.

NTPs on 3rd Cathy Loo-Shui, Garry McNaughton; 14th Kathy Martin, Jordan Disney.

Draw for Round 2 of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy: Brent Eather-Wayne Lang v John Donnelly-Robert Baker, Rod Pedron-Tim Parker v David Naveau-Garry McNaughton, Malcolm Payne-Save Kiss v Rod Irwin-David O'Brien, George Hollow-Gary Cusack v John Southwell-Doug Ney, Patrick Slack-Smith-Rob Parnell v Stephen Whiteman-Joe Ryan, Mitchell Cusack-Nathan Stewart v John Gersbach-



Rod Miller took out B grade monthly medal last week.

Peter Holden, David Wilson-Michael Britton lost to Marie Cornish-Teena Campbell, Ashley Bullock-David East v Elton Keeffe-Matt Ringland.

Round 2 matches are to be played by August 8.

This Saturday's events are a 4BALL Aggregate Stableford plus Round 16 of the Lion of Waterloo Trophy.

19th Hole

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